Enter the dragons

In the world of reptiles, dragons really do exist. These types of lizard often have incredible features that make them just as strange as the creatures found in fairy tales.

"Hey, watch the beard..."

This bearded dragon has a set of spiked scales around its throat, just like a man's beard. The "beard" expands so that the lizard will look too big for predators to swallow.

On the run

Most lizards get around on four legs, but – like people – the crested water dragon often uses just its two back (hind) legs when making a quick escape.



All talk, no action

If in danger, the frilled lizard opens its gaping mouth and spreads out an umbrella-like frill around its neck. This is to scare away any approaching predators.

Reptile file

- The eastern water dragon of Australia escapes from its enemies by diving underwater, where it can stay for up to 30 minutes.
- The frilled lizard's bright cape is a large flap of loose skin. When opened out, it can be more than four times the width of the lizard's body.